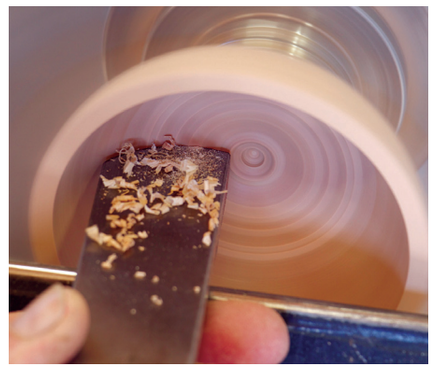
10 Turn the handles. If this looks a bit scary, that's because it is. The good news is that the handles can be sanded or carved with the lathe off, or even off the lathe. To turn the tops of the handles you need a delicate touch, as there's not much wood spinning around. I remove the bulk of the waste using the left wing of a ⅜-in. (10mm) deep-fluted bowl gouge, which must be rolled over at least 45° to avoid a severe catch. Refine the surface using a shear scraper on its edge. Never use a scraper flat on the rest in this situation or something similar like a natural-edge bowl rim.

11 Sand the inside and the handles. The handles are best power-sanded with the lathe turned off.

12 Mount the bowl over a jam chuck so you can remove the foot and finish the base. Use the tailcenter to ensure the bowl stays on the chuck. Here I use a flat center rather than a cone so the center doesn't penetrate the wood. This base remains rounded, but near flat at center so it won't roll over. All the turning can be done using a ⅜-in. (10mm) spindle gouge (my favorite detailing tool). Initially pull cuts remove the bulk of the waste and develop the curve, then after sanding all you can reach, take a shear cut towards the center, leaving a miniscule supporting nub that can be sanded away off the lathe. Alternatively you can use a skewed scraper flat on the rest.

13 Refine the handles and clean up the base. A small disk sander on the lathe is ideal for this task. ●

Mark the width of the rim. Hollow the bowl to the line you marked, initially using a bowl gouge



I prefer to hollow the bottom half using just a small portion of the edge of a large scraper

To safely turn the handles, shear scrape using the wing of the gouge (the gouge must be on its side to avoid a severe catch)...

... or use a shear scraper tilted on edge (and never flat on the rest)

Sand the handles with the lathe off. Off the lathe on the sander is a much safer option than turning. To refine and finish the base , mount the bowl...

... over a jam chuck with tailcenter support. Use a ⅜ in. (10mm) spindle or detail gouge to remove the foot. Blend any eccentricities with sanding

Remove the final nub using the nose of the spindle or detail gouge. As the lathe slows to a stop, a small shove with the gouge will shear the nub off the base, leaving you with minimal hand-sanding to finish the job

Any further detailing of the handles can be done off the lathe before the bowls are oiled. These bowls have a wingspan of about 8 in. (200mm). Two are redgum, the other camphor laurel

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